

Tab 1

The AIPAC Conspiracy and Qatari Influence in the US

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Introduction

Social media, an invention which revolutionized communication, has also increased political polarization worldwide. In recent months, one of the newest hot topics in the United States' digital ecosystem, a lightning rod of political conversation and debate, has been the supposed influence of the American Israel Public Affairs Committee, also known as AIPAC. AIPAC is an organization which works with both mainstream American political parties to promote legislation and candidates which help strengthen and maintain ties between the United States and Israel.¹ AIPAC receives money to help facilitate the promotion of the US-Israeli relationship through donations made by ordinary Americans who support Israel and the United States. An accusation made by social media users has framed this donated money as "dark money", with accusations of funding from a mysterious Jewish Lobby. These accusations have led many Jewish Americans to remember a past where conspiracy theories of a hidden Jewish power led to hatred and genocide against the Jews of Europe. The question which this paper answers is: Who is behind the resurgence and spread of anti-Semitic ideology in the United States? My research has found that Qatar, a small nation-state in the Middle East, has used its money and influence to shape the media's narrative on Israel/AIPAC and infiltrate the American educational system in order to promote its foreign policy objectives and Islamist agenda.

¹ The American Israel Public Affairs Committee. "AIPAC-Home Page." AIPAC.org, 2026, <https://www.aipac.org/>. Accessed 30 June 2026

AIPAC and Conspiracy Theories

The American Israel Public Affairs Committee's influence in the US has been characterized by social media users as manipulative and harmful towards the United States populace. As such, due to the organization's advocacy for Israel, the Jewish State, anti-Semitic conspiracy theories have floated around for decades about the purpose and scope of AIPAC. One of the most popular and enduring conspiracy theories about AIPAC relates to it being some sort of shadowy organization which drags the United States into foreign conflict. This has led conspiracy theorists to falsely theorize that AIPAC helped orchestrate the tragic 9/11 Jihadist attacks in order to create a false flag attack to justify the invasion of Iraq.² Although the Iraqi government, led by Saddam Hussein, was a major adversary of Israel, Iraq was no friend of the United States either. This conspiracy theory also loses traction due to the fact that the airplane hijackers belonged to Al Qaeda, a terrorist organization which believes in Israel's destruction due to its perceived illegitimacy. The actual invasion of Iraq has also been confirmed to have been a decision made by a panicked Bush Administration, which used cherry-picked intelligence data that confirmed their belief of an imminent threat from Saddam Hussein's government.³ Despite the clear indications that AIPAC had no involvement or motive in the 9/11 attacks, Americans may gravitate towards this conspiracy theory, as this simple explanation confirms previously held beliefs of a hidden Jewish influence. Specifically, "These theories are often framed in a way that portrays Jews as a monolithic group with hidden agendas, echoing centuries-old

² Youvan, Douglas C. Page 16 "The Role of AIPAC and Israel in 9/11: Analyzing the Persistence of Conspiracy Theories and Their Sociopolitical Impact." (2024).

³ Rabinovich, Itamar. "Testing the 'Israel Lobby' Thesis" | Brookings. Brookings Institution, 1 March 2008, <https://www.brookings.edu/articles/testing-the-israel-lobby-thesis/>. Accessed 15 June 2026.

accusations of Jewish conspiracies, such as those found in the infamous Protocols of the Elders of Zion".⁴ While AIPAC has had its triumphs in promoting Israel as an ally for the United States, its success has not reached as far as conspiracy theories claim. In fact, despite its supposed influence on the United States, AIPAC has made little effort to influence American youth, in comparison to its Islamist counterparts like CAIR (the Council on American-Islamic Relations), which has ties to the government of Qatar.

Foreign Interference: Qatar's Influence on the United States

Qatar is a small country in the Gulf Region of the Middle East, with immense oil wealth and an authoritarian monarch.⁵ Qatar has long had ties to overseas Islamist organizations, with its support of the Muslim Brotherhood leading to a diplomatic firestorm between itself and Saudi Arabia. The Qatari Emir also helped fund the Muslim Student Alliance's multi-million-dollar HQ construction in 1983,⁶ which has direct ties to the controversial and influential organization, CAIR.⁷

The Council on American-Islamic Relations (CAIR) has become more prominent in its influence in both the educational and political arenas. Despite posing as a civil rights organization, CAIR has publicly defended both terrorist organizations and extremist clerics who have advocated for violence against non-muslims in the West.⁸

One of the major controversies involving CAIR and its association with terrorist

⁴ Youvan, Douglas C. Page 22 "The Role of AIPAC and Israel in 9/11: Analyzing the Persistence of Conspiracy Theories and Their Sociopolitical Impact." (2024).

⁵ Anthony, John Duke, Crystal, Jill Ann, Zeidan, Adam. "Qatar". Encyclopedia Britannica, 30 Jun. 2026, <https://www.britannica.com/place/Qatar>. Accessed 30 June 2026.

⁶ Barsky, Yehudit, and Ehud Rosen. "Islamist Antisemitism in the United States." Page 6 (2023).

⁷ Gutfeld, Arnon. "The saudi specter over the american education system." Jewish Political Studies Review 29.1/2 (2018): 66-87.

⁸ Barsky, Yehudit, and Ehud Rosen. "Islamist Antisemitism in the United States." Page 7 (2023).

organizations was when CAIR was named as an (uncharged) co-conspirator by the United States Department of Justice in a case against the Holy Land Foundation. The HLF was a charity organization convicted of financing Hamas by giving the terrorist group 12 million dollars. Despite the HLF's direct connections to Hamas, CAIR provided aid and support to the Holy Land Foundation during the trial. Aside from this scandal, 5 of the original founders of CAIR were originally a part of the Islamic Association for Palestine (IAP), which was disbanded after the US government accused the organization of being a part of Hamas's "propaganda apparatus".⁹ Despite their links to terrorist organizations, including Hamas, CAIR continues to present itself as a protector of American Muslims and their human rights. However, this Islamist influence did not appear out of nowhere.

On American University campuses, Qatar has spent billions of dollars to promote its Islamist agenda. In fact, according to the US Department of Education, Qatar has spent the LARGEST amount of money on foreign "gifts" towards US universities across every country on the planet. The money that Qatar has publicly spent to influence American higher educational institutions has been reported to be at 8.8 billion dollars.¹⁰ Qatar's large amounts of spending on donations towards American universities have been used to promote Islamist ideology and create an influence amongst faculty and students which advances Qatari interests. Beyond US universities, Qatar contributed

⁹ ADL-Center on Extremism. "The Council on American Islamic Relations (CAIR)." ADL, <https://www.adl.org/resources/backgrounders/council-american-islamic-relations-cair>. Accessed 29 June 2026.

¹⁰ US Department of Education. "Section 117 Foreign Gift & Contract Reporting." Section 117 Foreign Gift and Contract Public Transparency Dashboard, United States Government, 2026, <https://www.foreignfundinghighered.gov/>. Accessed 18 June 2026.

\$30.6 million in funding to K-12 schools in the United States.¹¹ These Qatari influences have caused the demonization of Jewish students and the sanitization of jihadist organizations. As such, Qatar aims to change institutional norms across the United States, to strengthen its radical goals and facilitate a promotion of its extremist ideology.¹²

Outside of the American education system, Qatar has also used its propaganda outlet, Al Jazeera, to spread disinformation and promote Qatar's foreign policy objectives amongst the US population. Al Jazeera has been publicized by Qatar and its allies as a reputable source that gives Western audiences a look into things which local media do not have access to or refuse to reveal. The framing presented by Al Jazeera has made American audiences believe that the news organization presents itself as less biased than American news companies and willing to show other points of view, rather than ones which represent traditional Western values.¹³ However, what many Al Jazeera watchers fail to understand is that the news presented on the platform is meant to exploit American dissatisfaction with traditional media outlets and radicalize the American population to align with Qatar's extreme point of view. Al Jazeera English was one of the first organizations to spread the false rumor that Israel bombed the Al-Ahli Hospital in Gaza, despite flimsy evidence. Later, after the rumor of this supposed Israeli war crime was debunked based on audio and visual evidence, the supposed

¹¹ Alfonsi, Dr. Sandra. For Purchase: K-12 and Academia. Buyers: Saudi Arabia and Qatar. Accessed 5 July 2026.

¹² Jain, Sushil K. "The Crescent in Christendom: Muslim Politicians and Political Mobilization in the West, Post-1960." *Post-1960* (March 27, 2025) (2025).

¹³ Samuel-Azran, Tal, and Ilan Manor. "Empirical support for the Al-Jazeera Effect notion: Al-Jazeera's Twitter following." *International Communication Gazette* 85.5 (2023): 386-411.

information that Al Jazeera received stemmed from a conversation with an employee from the Hamas-run Ministry of Health.¹⁴ Al Jazeera has also promoted heinous antisemitic conspiracy theories that have even included Holocaust denial. In fact, Al Jazeera released a documentary in May 2019, refuting the Holocaust's horrors and insinuating that the genocide was a Zionist plot.¹⁵ As such, Qatar has used its propaganda outlets' gained legitimacy to increase antisemitic thought amongst Al Jazeera's viewers.

AIPAC vs Qatari Lobbies

With the notion of AIPAC's perceived outsized, ever-increasing influence on the United States, the centuries-old myth of Jewish societal control has reemerged and begun to become a part of mainstream political ideology in the US. However, this view does not take into account the presence of the more powerful Qatari Lobby, which has aggressively pursued its policy goals in the United States. With AIPAC spending \$42.21 million over the past two years in pushing pro-Israel candidates,¹⁶ the Qatari Lobby has spent almost 250 million dollars on US lobbying firms, and 6.25 billion dollars on "gifts" to US universities. The Qatari government also has in-depth ties in the Trump

¹⁴ O'Donoghue, Rachel. "5 Media Misquotes That Tarnished Israel's Image During the War." Honest Reporting, 2 April 2024, <https://honestreporting.com/5-media-misquotes-that-tarnished-israels-image-during-the-war/>. Accessed 23 June 2026.

¹⁵ Merlin, Ohad. "Al-Jazeera's Holocaust legacy: Justification alongside outright denial." The Jerusalem Post, 6 May 2024, <https://www.jpost.com/middle-east/al-jazeeras-holocaust-legacy-justification-alongside-outright-denial-800079>. Accessed 23 June 2026. antisemitic

¹⁶ Federal Election Commission. "AMERICAN ISRAEL PUBLIC AFFAIRS COMMITTEE POLITICAL ACTION COMMITTEE - committee overview." FEC, <https://www.fec.gov/data/committee/C00797670/>. Accessed 29 June 2026.

administration with both FBI director Kash Patel and Attorney General Pam Bondi, being former Qatari lobbyist consultants.¹⁷ As a result of Qatar's efforts, the small country has exerted immense influence on both the US government and the American education system. According to the author Robert B. Spencer, this strategy used by Qatar and other Islamists is called soft jihad. Spencer views soft jihad as non-violent compared to violent jihad, and it is meant to influence Western institutions in an Islamist direction.¹⁸ This amount of soft power has given Qatar a disproportionate influence in the United States, leading the country to become one of AIPAC's adversaries in the US lobbying world. While foreign lobbying is legal in the United States, the extreme amount of influence that Qatar has built up in the US has been seen as a threat to Jewish communities due to Qatar's ties with Hamas and the Iranian regime. Al Jazeera's increasing influence and its spread of anti-AIPAC propaganda seem to have been a deliberate strategy by the Qatari royal family to increase its influence in the United States. As of July 1st 2026, the current CEO of Al Jazeera is Nasser al Thani, who is a member of the Qatari royal family.¹⁹ Partially due to this direct tie with the Qatari Royal family, the Qatari government has direct responsibility for Al Jazeera promoting anti-Semitic rhetoric which reinforces the AIPAC conspiracies.

¹⁷ Freeman, Ben, et al. "Soft Power, Hard Influence: How Qatar Became a Giant in Washington." Quincy Institute, 8 September 2025, <https://quincyinst.org/research/soft-power-hard-influence-how-qatar-became-a-giant-in-washington/#>. Accessed 29 June 2026.

¹⁸ Spencer, Robert. *Stealth jihad*. Skyhorse Publishing, 2008. Accessed 11 July 2026.

¹⁹ Barsky, Anna. "Israel concerned over Al Jazeera neutrality as Qatar replaces CEO with royal family member." *The Jerusalem Post*, 2 September 2025, <https://www.jpost.com/middle-east/article-866064>. Accessed 1 July 2026.

Conclusion

Although Qatar is far from being the sole perpetrator of rising anti-Semitism, it is essential for organizations and governments which are attempting to combat anti-Semitism to hold the Qatari government accountable for its funding of harmful rhetoric. The promotion of anti-Semitic ideology has real consequences, beyond the perceived goal of the Qatari government, which seems to be strengthening the country's foreign influence. These consequences have led to an increasing rise in anti-Jewish hatred and countless attacks against Jewish people and communities. For example, according to the FBI, Jewish Americans are the second most affected group by hate crimes in the United States, with Black Americans being targeted the most.²⁰ The large number of hate crimes committed against Jewish people over the past 5 years (8,106 anti-Semitic crimes) has seemingly become justified under the banner of resistance against Israel and the cloak of anti-Zionism. Anti-Semitic social media accounts have increasingly framed their attacks on Jewish institutions and organizations as a battle of justice for the Palestinian People. Due to this, it is essential to combat Qatari influence in both the academic system and the media landscape to create a future where Jewish people are able to walk in public without the fear of being attacked by individuals who have been brainwashed into a cycle of hatred.

²⁰ FBI. "Hate Crime in the United States Incident Analysis." FBI Crime Data Explorer, FBI Uniform Crime Reporting Program, <https://cde.ucr.cjis.gov/LATEST/webapp/#/pages/explorer/crime/hate-crime>. Accessed 29 June 2026.

Tab 2

